



Food and Agriculture
Organization of the
United Nations

Sustainable soil and fertilizer management in Africa (Fertilizer Code)

27th of April 2023

Vinisa Saynes Santillán, GSP Secretariat

Sustainable
soil and fertilizer
management for Africa:
a case study from Uganda



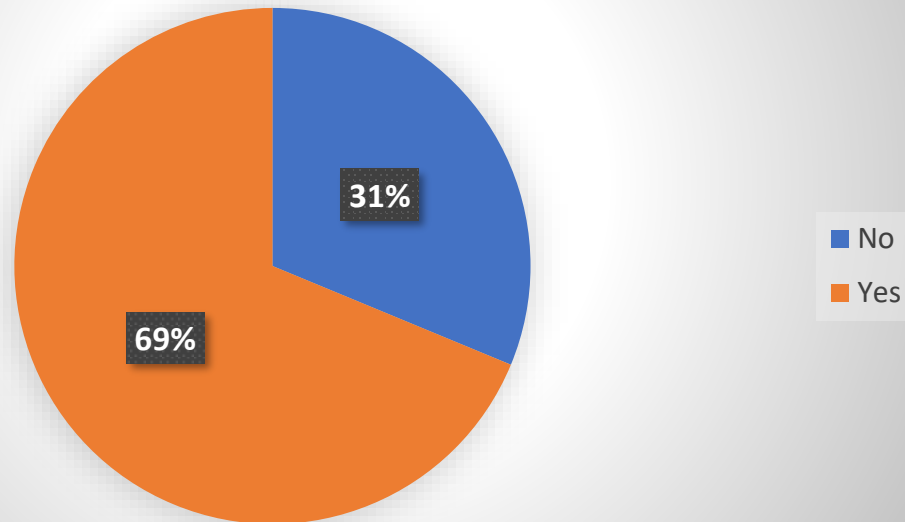
MAAIF

Ministry of Agriculture
Animal Industry and Fisheries



The International Code of Conduct for the Sustainable Use

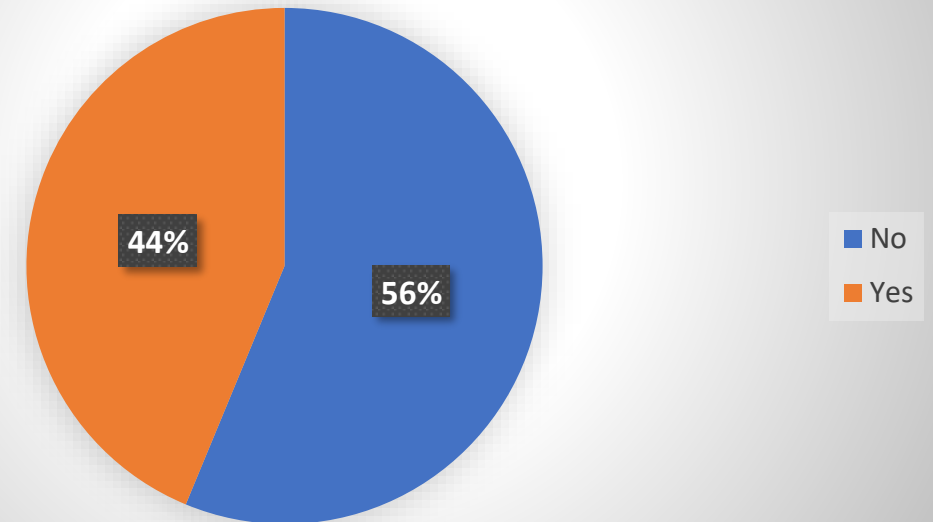
Awareness of the existence of the Fertilizer Code in Africa



What is it?

The Code is an instrument to provide a locally adaptable

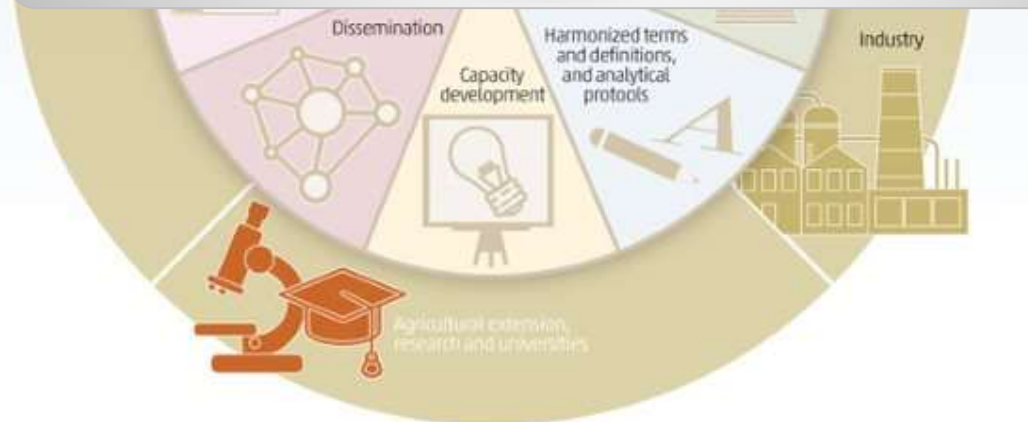
Implementation of actions based on the Fertilizer Code in Africa



How to implement it?

Full support from governments, FAO and other international institutions

Available for all stakeholders



se study from Uganda | 27th of April 2023



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The Global Symposium on Soils for Nutrition (GSOIL4N)

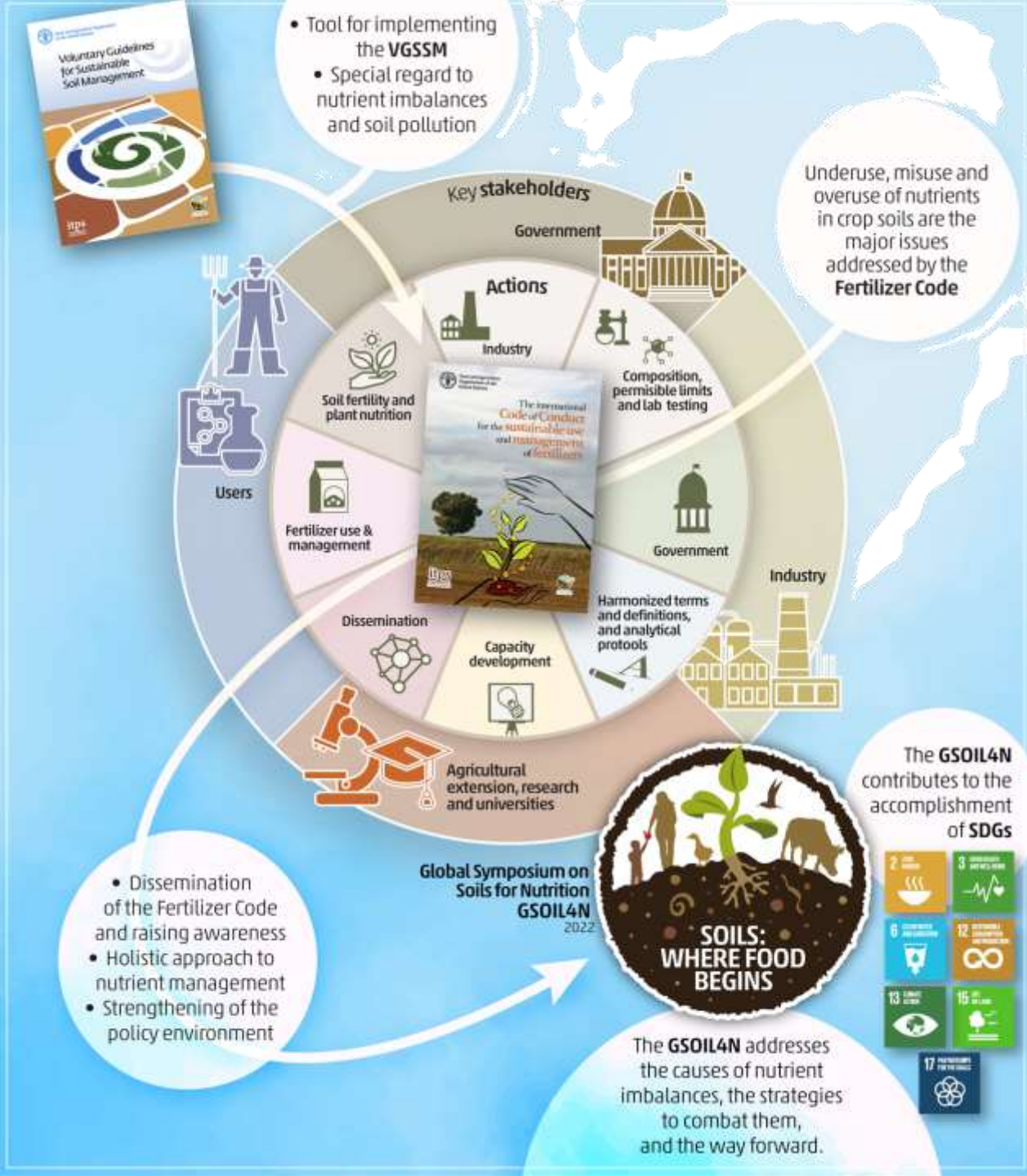


Sustainable soil and fertilizer management for Africa: a case study from **Uganda** | 27th of April 2023

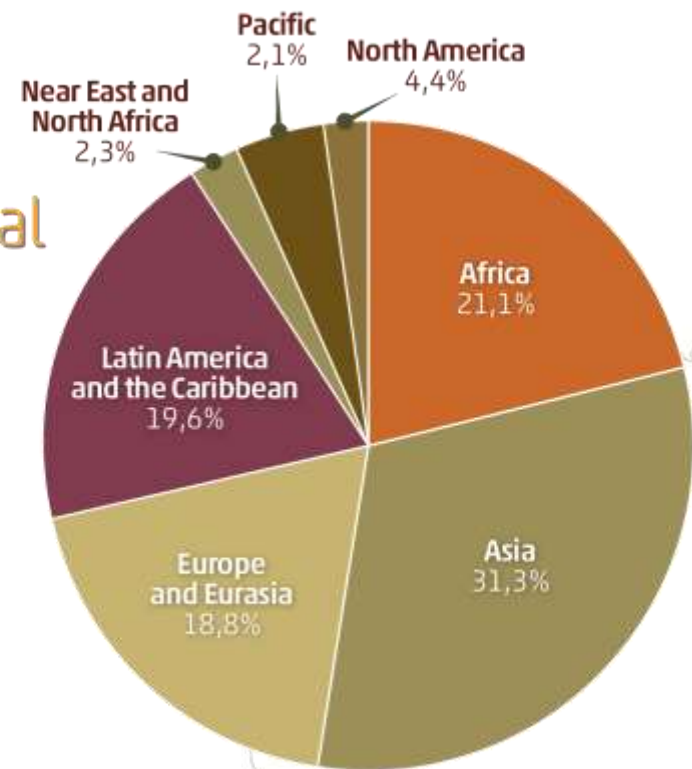


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Regional balance



- ✓ 17 abstracts
- ✓ 12 countries
- ✓ Themes: organic and inorganic fertilizers, soil fertility management, hidden hunger, composting, alternative materials, extension.
- ✓ Multisectoral panels
- ✓ Keynote speakers
- ✓ Recommendations

Cameroon
Côte d'Ivoire
Ethiopia
Ghana
Madagascar
Malawi
Mozambique
Niger
Nigeria
Senegal
Tanzania
Uganda

Six general recommendations after the GSOIL4N



- 1 Map and monitor soil nutrients and soil fertility. Deepen the knowledge on soil nutrient budget

M o n i t o r i n g



- 2 Develop innovative approaches and alternative products to optimize soil nutrient content, enhance fertilizer use efficiency, and reduce externalities associated with soil fertility management

I n n o v a t i o n s



- 3 Assess the quality and safety of all nutrient sources applied to soils to avoid or reduce environmental contamination and health problems

Q u a l i t y

Six general recommendations after the GSOL4N

4



Advocate for the adoption of SSM practices since it still represents the most cost-effective solution to increase soil nutrient content

S S M

5



Advocate for the inclusion of soil fertility and soil health in the legal framework of countries in relation to the One health approach linking human nutrition, environmental and soil health.

**S o i l
g o v e r n a n c e**

6



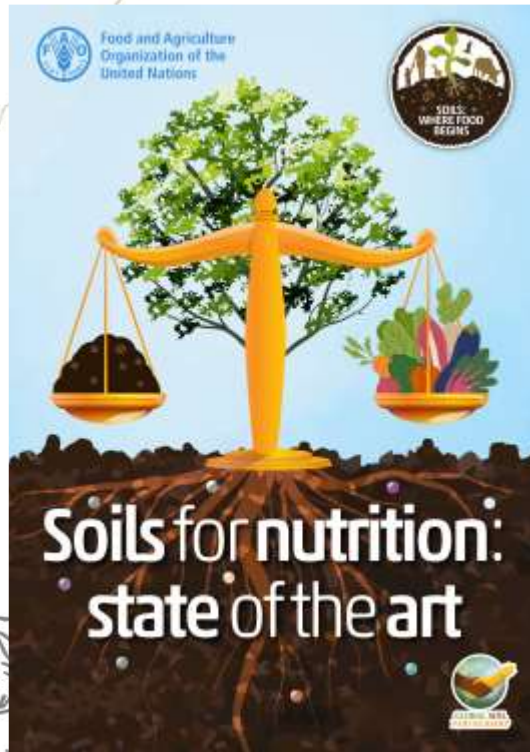
Consider driving forces such as water availability, climate change, poverty and the fertilizer crisis and promote a soils for nutrition agenda.

M u l t i f a c t o r i a l

Soils 4 nutrition enhanced

The vision of soils as a source of nutrients we all need to survive was enhanced and supported by

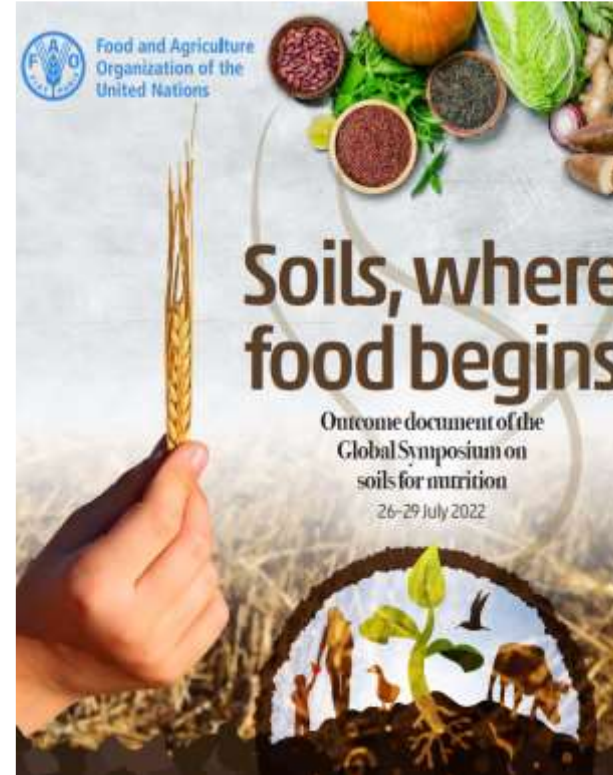
Booklet



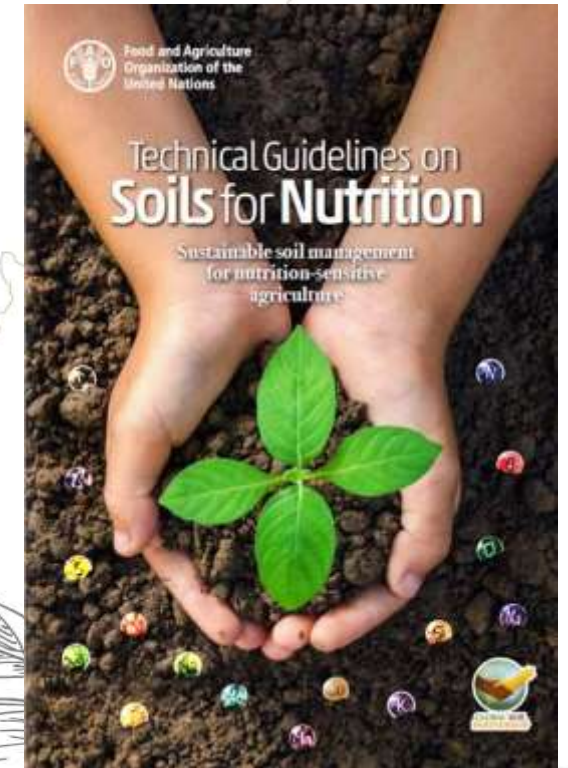
ITPS Letter



Outcome Document



Technical Guidelines



THE NATIONAL SURVEY ON THE USE AND MANAGEMENT OF FERTILIZERS



What for?

- ✓ To address and collate information about the causes leading to the underuse, misuse, and overuse of fertilizers at the country level
- ✓ To better understand the current use and fertilizer management, the gaps, and challenges for their sustainable use.



147 participants from
61 countries
responded to the
survey which will
support the action
plan for the
implementation of
The Fertilizer Code



<1%

NA

1 Country



53%

LAC

15 Countries



14%

Europa

9 Countries



4%

NENA

6 Countries



11%

Africa

13 Countries



3%

Eurasia

4 Countries



13%

Asia

11 Countries

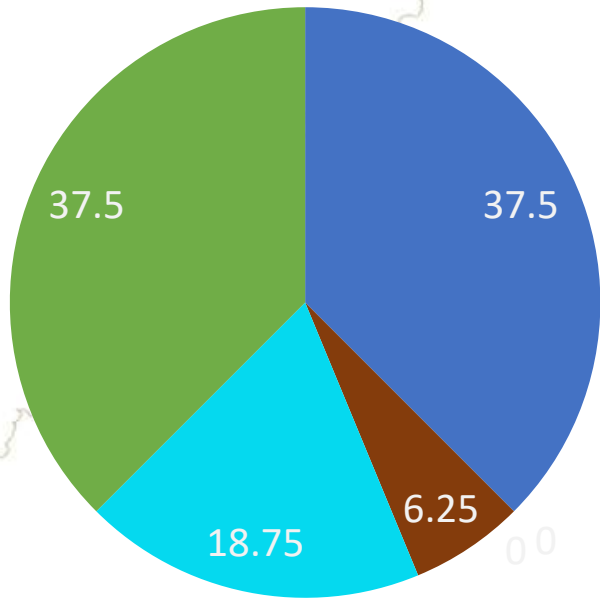


<1%

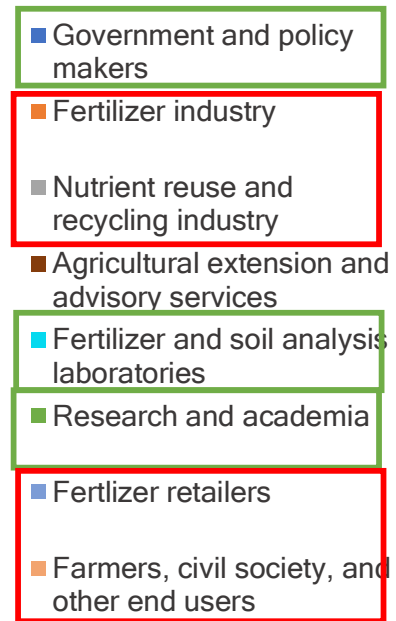
Pacific

2 Countries

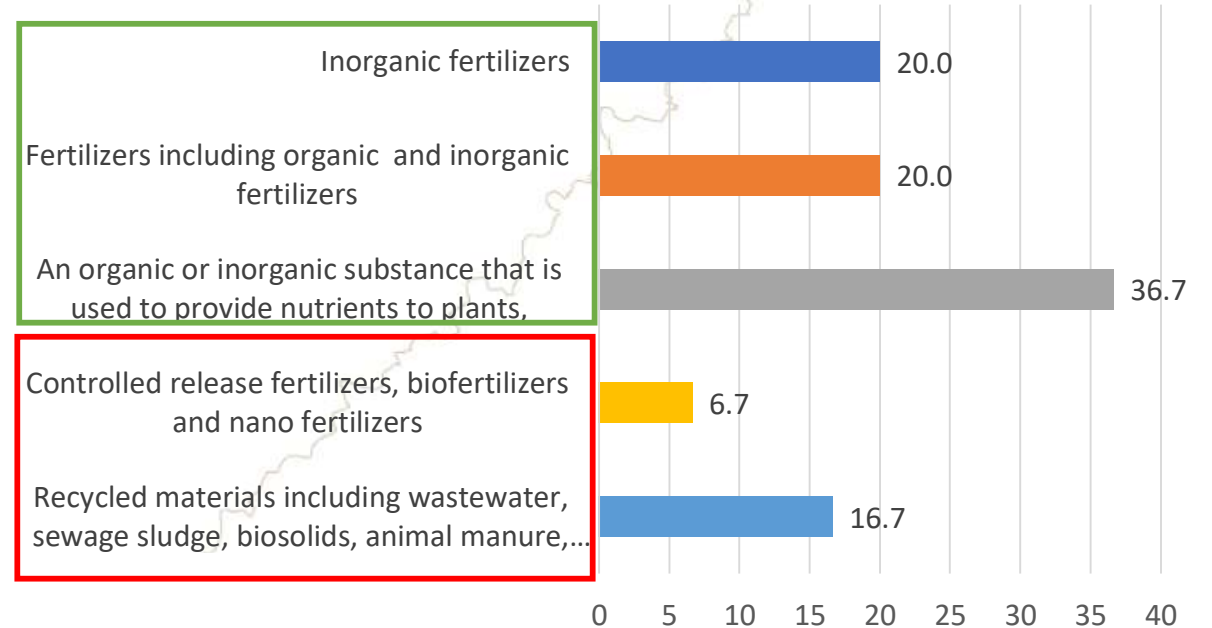
Burkina Faso
Senegal
Gabon
Republic of
Congo
Togo
Kenya
Uganda
Malawi
Sierra Leone
Nigeria
Eswatini
Ghana
Eritrea



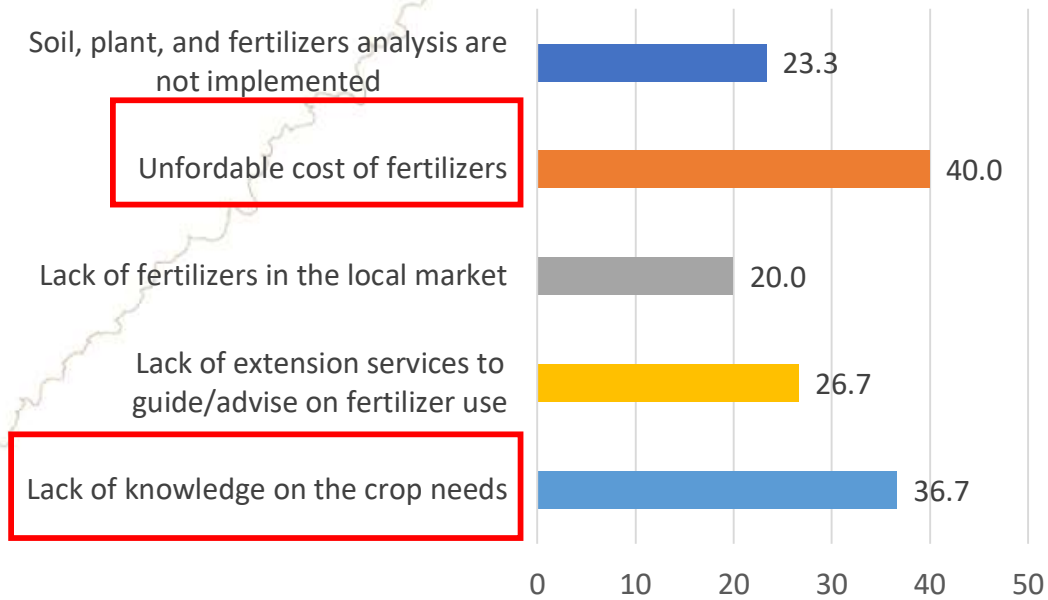
The perception of fertilizers



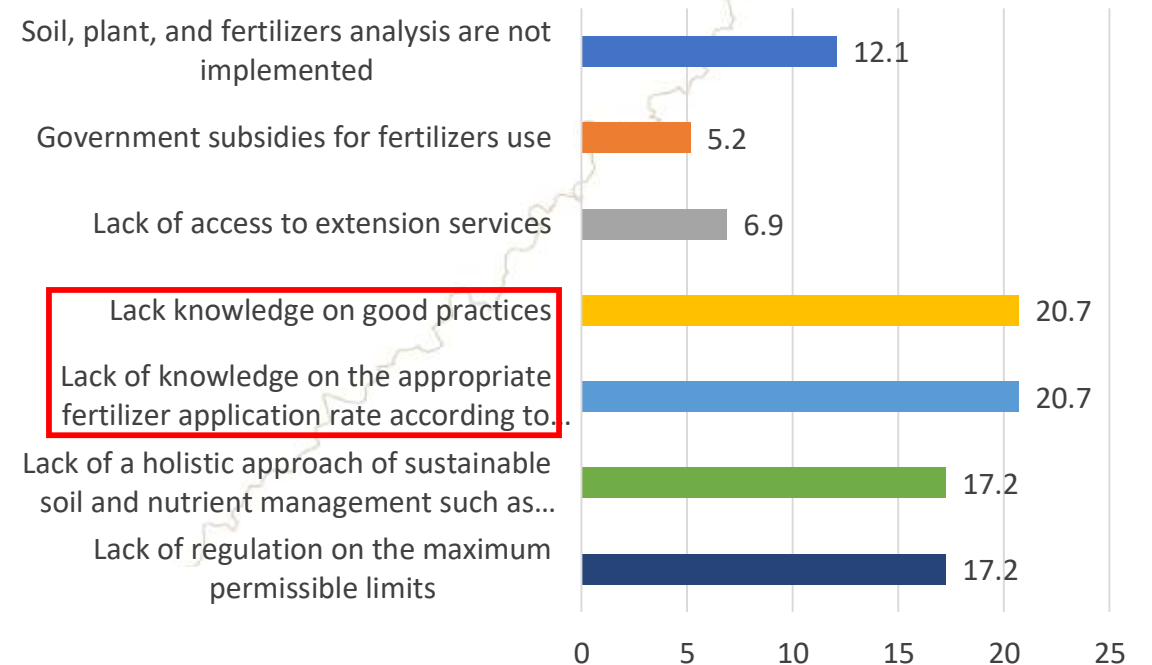
Participation by sector



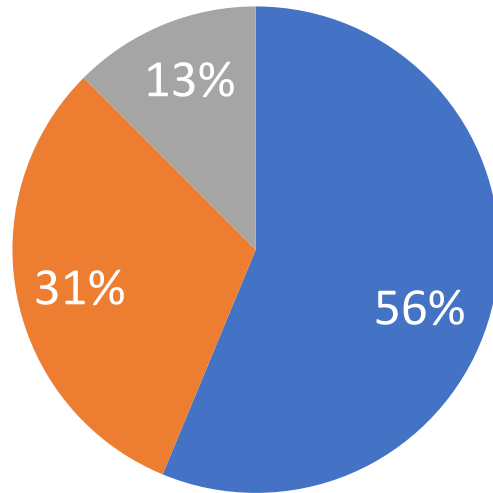
Factors leading to underuse



Factors leading to overuse



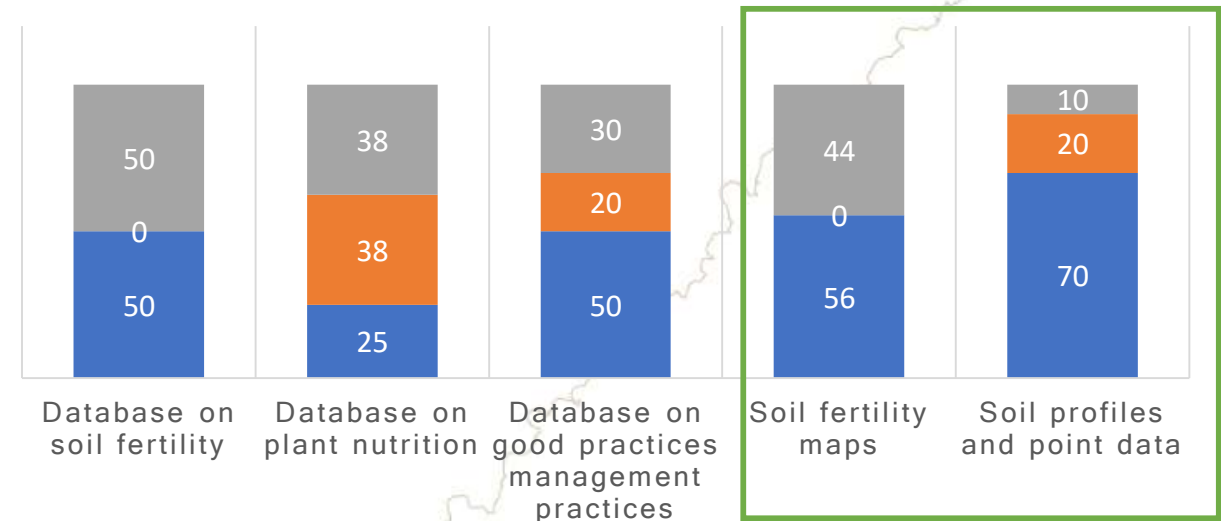
Does your country monitor activities related to soil fertility?



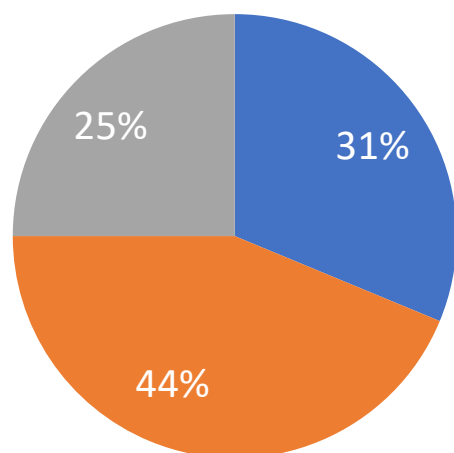
■ Yes ■ No ■ I do not know

Components included in the national soil information system:

■ Yes ■ No ■ In development

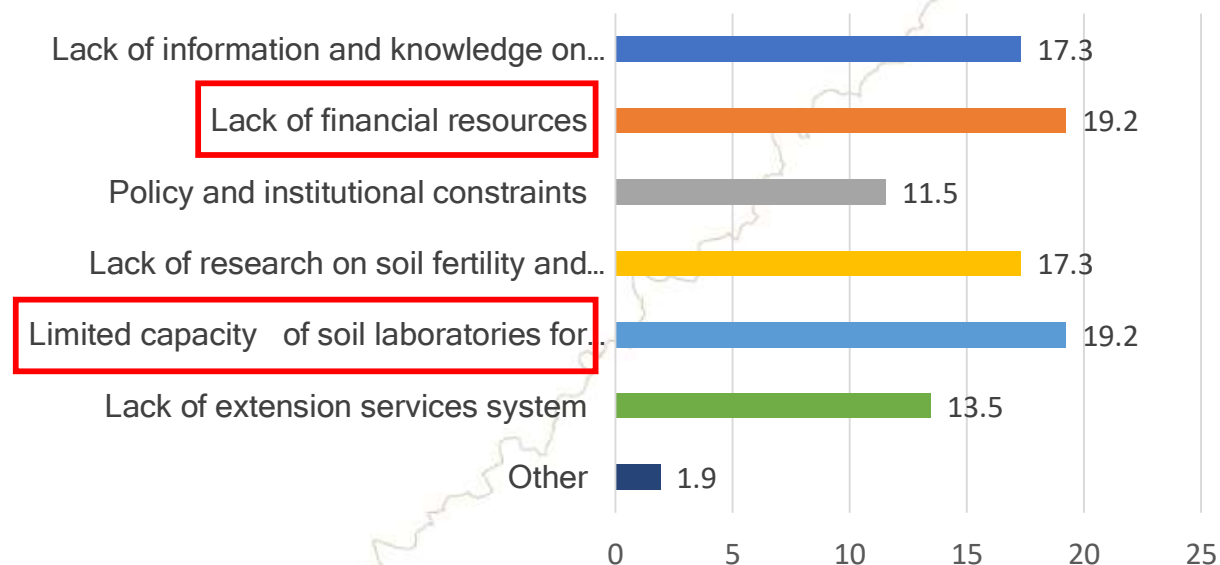


Does your country have any fertilization extension services system?



■ Yes ■ No ■ I do not know

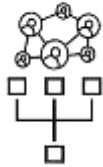
Barriers to implement sustainable use and management strategies of fertilizers in the country



International Network on Fertilizer Analysis



1



Harmonization of Methodologies for Fertilizers Analysis

- Standardization of fertilizer analysis methods
- Harmonization of fertilizer classification and definitions

2



Capacity Building/Strengthening

- Strengthen performance of fertilizer laboratories using standardized methods
- Provide training guidelines (literature + media)

3



Governance, Policy and Regulation

- Regulatory framework regarding fertilizer use and imports at the national, regional and global levels (database)
- Development of policy guidelines for fertilizer quality requirements



INFA in Africa

40



Laboratories have
joined INFA

24%



INFA has representation in 23 countries in Africa
Botswana, Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Cape Verde, Côte
d'Ivoire, Eswatini, Gabon, Ghana, Kenya, Lesotho,
Malawi, Mali, Mozambique, Niger, Nigeria, Sao Tome e
Principe, Senegal, South Africa, Tanzania, The Gambia,
Togo, Uganda, and Zimbabwe)

INFA counts on 165 members
operating in 84 countries

Kind request for Africa



Encourage (via support from GSP Focal Points) soil laboratories and other key stakeholders to join INFA and implement agreed activities including harmonization, policy and regulations;



Join INFA!

Avoid underuse, misuse and overuse of fertilizers and use alternative nutrient sources



Support The Fertilizer Code implementation

Support the implementation of the GSOIL4N recommendations



MAAIF
Ministry of Agriculture
Animal Industry and Fisheries



Thank you for your attention!

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Animal Industry and Fisheries

Jointly organized by FAO
and the Ministry of Agriculture Animal Industry
and Fisheries of Uganda

Thanks to the financial support of



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